



Assignment Cover Sheet	
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University
of Exeter

Marketing in Practice BEMM215

Individual Report 1

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**MSc Marketing
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Executive Summary

The Isles of Scilly Steamship Group (ISSG) has identified an opportunity to increase demand for its services by targeting the 18-35 age group. This marketing plan addresses that opportunity. By using the core competencies of the company to develop a boutique experience, the World's First Island Hopping Festival, this plan is forecast to achieve these overall objectives by the end of the 2026 season:

- A 30% increase in youth awareness
- A 25% uplift in engagement among the target market
- A 20% growth in revenue from younger travellers

For the recommended activation, a budget of £150,000 is required, with an anticipated ROI of between 300% and 500%. Both costs and revenue have been estimated at this stage, and can be refined further following approval in principle. Key elements of the activation are bundled travel packages, youth pricing incentives, influencer-led content and university partnerships.

This marketing plan applies the SOSTAC framework to critically analyse ISSG's internal and external environment and propose targeted solutions. The plan also includes longer-term opportunities to build on the island's sustainability credentials, continuing to expand demand among other audiences.

Keywords: Isles of Scilly, IST, SOSTAC, Island-Hopping Festival, Gen Z, Millennials, Experiential Marketing, Sustainability, Digital Strategy, Future-Proofing

Table of Contents

Executive Summary.....	2
1. Introduction	7
2. Situation Analysis	7
2.1 Macro Analysis	7
2.2 Micro Analysis	9
2.3 Internal Analysis	10
2.4 Market Analysis	11
Broad Overview	11
Consumer Behaviour.....	11
Competitor Analysis	11
2.5 SWOT	12
2.6 TOWS	12
3. SMARTER Objectives.....	13
3.1 Marketing Objectives	13
3.2 Financial Objectives	13
4. Strategy.....	14
4.1 Ansoff Matrix	14
4.2 STP	15
Segmentation.....	15
Values, Attitudes and Lifestyles (VALS).....	16
4.3 Targeting	16
4.4 Personas	16
4.5 Positioning	18
Perceptual Map	19
5. Tactics	19
5.1 Campaign Big Idea and Key Message	19
Justification	20
5.2 Marketing Mix	21
5.3 Content Strategy.....	22
5.4 Channel Breakdown (using RACE).....	22
Reach	22
Act.....	27
Convert.....	30
Engage.....	33
6. Action	36
6.1 Pre-Campaign Gantt Chart	36
6.2 Campaign Rollout Timeline: January 2026 - December 2026	37
6.3 Roles & Responsibilities.....	38

6.4 Budget	39
7. Control.....	42
7.1 KPIs & Metrics	42
7.2 Financial Evaluation	43
Pricing	43
Returns on Investment (ROI)	44
Checkpoints	44
7.3 Risk & Mitigation	45
8. Long-Term Recommendations.....	47
8.1 Market Penetration	47
8.2 Product Development	48
8.3 Diversification	49
9. Conclusion.....	50

Table #	Table Title	Page #
1	PES - Macro Analysis	7
2	TEL - Macro Analysis	8
3	Porter's Five Forces (pt 1.)	9
4	Porter's Five Forces (pt 2.)	9
5	5M Model (pt 1.)	10
6	5M Model (pt 2.)	10
7	Competitor Analysis	11
8	SWOT	12
9	TOWS	12
10	Ansoff Matrix	14
11	Segmentation (Current)	15
12	Segmentation (Strategy)	15
13	Targeting	16
14	4Cs	18
15	Campaign Idea	19
16	4Ps	20
17	3Ps	21
18	Content Strategy	21
19	Social Media Content Type	22
20	Website Experience	27
21	Social Interactivity	29
22	Festival Program	31
23	Bundles	33
24	UGC Locations	33
25	Content Series	35
26	Merch	35
27	Pre-Campaign Gantt Chart	36
28	Timeline Justifications pt 1.	37
29	Timeline Justifications pt 2.	38
30	Roles	38
31	Digital Marketing Budget	39
32	Engagement and Outreach Budget	40
33	Festival Experience Budget pt 1.	40
34	Festival Experience Budget pt 2.	41
35	Operational Costs	41
36	Marketing Objectives	42
37	Financial Objectives	43
38	Pricing	43
39	Bundle Pricing	44
40	ROI on 3000 attendees	44
41	Checkpoints	44
42	Internal Risks	46
43	External Risks	46
44	Long-Term Ansoff Matrix	47
45	Long-Term: Loyalty Program	47

46	Long-Term: Work-Event Package	49
47	Long-Term: “Eco-Lodges”	50

Figure #	Figure Title	Page #
1	Persona #1	17
2	Persona #2	18
3	Perceptual Map	19
4	Festival Banner	20
5	Sample Instagram Post	23
6	Sample Instagram Story	24
7	Sample Influencer	25
8	Pop-ups	26
9	Campus Media	26
10	Landing Page	27
11	Travel Info Page	28
12	Polls	30
13	Purchase Flow	30
14	Logo	31
15	Festival Pass	33
16	UGC Post	34
17	Sample Hoodie	36
18	Timeline	37
19	Budget Pie Chart	42
20	Risk Heat Map	46
21	ScillyMiles App	48
22	Brochure	49
23	Eco-Lodges	50

1. Introduction

The Isles of Scilly Steamship Group (ISSG) has served as the lifeline of the Isles of Scilly for over a century, providing vital sea and air transport links between the islands and the mainland. The company operates through two divisions: Isles of Scilly Travel (IST), which manages passenger services, and Isles of Scilly Freight (ISF), which supports cargo transport. Each year, IST carries more than 190,000 passengers; however, over half of this customer base is aged 50 or above (Sandercock, 2025). To ensure long-term resilience, ISSG must broaden its appeal to younger travellers. This report applies the SOSTAC framework to examine the organisation's environment and deliver evidence-based recommendations critically. The outcome will be a comprehensive marketing plan designed to attract and engage younger audiences, thereby future-proofing the business.

2. Situation Analysis

2.1 Macro Analysis

PESTEL	General Impact	Opportunity / Threat
P = Political UK Government offered £48.5 in Levelling-Up funding to replace older ferries and infrastructure (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2023).	Bureaucratic delays and changing terms meant IST looked for private funding (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2023). While government funding is inconsistent it shows good will by residents to support the business.	+1 Opportunity
E = Economic Demand for overseas holidays has increased following Covid. Domestic visits declined, as shown by Cornwall's lower tourist numbers in 2024 compared to 2019 (Green & Thorpe, 2025).	The demand for staycations and domestic holidays during Covid is no longer in effect. IST and Scilly will see lower demand.	-2 Threat
S = Social - Demand for holidays varies depending on season. - ISSG and IST has a deep rooted history with the locals.	- The Scilly Isles main season is March to November (Client Brief). This broad window however will see peaks during May-August. - The history and good-will of the people keeps consistent demand.	+1 Opportunity

Table 1: PES - Macro Analysis (Author's own, 2025)

The key takeaway is that strong local ties have benefited IST, but tourist demand has declined due to growing interest in overseas travel.

PESTEL	General Impact	Opportunity / Threat
T = Technology Technological innovation enables cleaner, fuel-efficient engines. IST is leveraging this by commissioning two new ferries using such technology (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2024a).	The ability to retrofit new vessels with hybrid/electric propulsion keeps ISSG ahead of the sustainability curve.	+2 Opportunity
E = Environment Severe weather events have become more frequent - winter storms can cancel sailings and flights, and unpredictable weather even in shoulder seasons creates operational challenges.	Drastic weather can cause more travel cancellations, port damage, or schedule unreliability. This can harm IST's reliability and reputation.	-1 Threat
L = Legal - Maritime law (UK and international) mandates regular safety inspections, crew training, and vessel certifications. - Skybus operates under Civil Aviation Authority rules.	ISSG must meet strict UK maritime and aviation safety laws, shaping operations, fleet investment, and risk management- making legal compliance essential to service delivery.	-1 Threat

Table 2: TEL - Macro Analysis (Author's own, 2025)

IST is investing in sustainable ferries, but weather risks remain outside its control

2.2 Micro Analysis

Forces	Impact on IST
Threat of New Entrants • High barriers to entry: To enter the market a new entrant would need vessels/aircraft and infrastructure which is considerable costly. • Cultural and historical connection: IST has a deep history with Scilly. A new entrant would need a strong USP to overcome this connection.	Low
Threat of Substitutes • Other holiday destinations: Tourists can easily opt for cheaper alternatives, whether overseas or closer to home in Cornwall.	High
Bargaining Power of Suppliers • Bound to critical infrastructure: IST depends on infrastructure like airports and harbours. St. Mary's Airport, owned by the council, planned an 18% rise in landing and service fees last year-posing a significant cost impact (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2024b).	Moderate

Table 3: Porter's Five Forces (pt 1.) (Author's own, 2025)

The main micro-level threat to IST is substitution, with Scilly competing against both exotic overseas trips and more convenient holidays in Cornwall.

Forces	Impact on IST
Bargaining Power of Buyers • Tourists: Tourists are elastic and very price determent. However, if trying to visit Isles of Scilly there are limited alternatives. • Residents: Residents could rally together for cheaper prices or better services as they hold influence as a collective. However, this is unlikely.	Low
Competitors Rivalry • Monopoly: IST used to be a monopoly until Penzance Helicopters opened in 2020 which now has taken 27% of market share (Sandercock, 2025).	Low

Table 4: Porter's Five Forces (pt 2.) (Author's own, 2025)

IST's dominance has helped it to completely resist competitive forces.

2.3 Internal Analysis

Table 5 shows loyal staff and strong infrastructure aid reliability, though seasonal strain adds costs.

5M Framework	Details	Insights
Manpower	200+ staff incl. pilots, crew, engineers. Local roots and community loyalty. Training cadets and promoting internally. Diverse team with growing female representation	Strong operational capability and service quality built on experienced staff. Seasonal strain and limited progression challenge morale.
Materials	Owens Land's End Airport; upgraded runways and terminal. Digital booking system, integrated multimodal transport. Coordination between Penzance and St. Mary's operations.	Robust infrastructure enables reliability. But dependency on external harbours and island geography pose material challenges and cost pressures.

Table 5: 5M Model (pt 1.) (Author's own, 2025)

Table 6 shows that while ageing assets pose risks, upgrades boost resilience; ISSG's service focus and monopoly add stability, though competition and pricing remain pressures.

5M Framework	Details	Insights
Machinery	Fleet: 3 ships, 8 aircraft. Scillonian III aging; Scillonian IV due 2026. Skybus uses small aircraft (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2024) Ongoing £40m vessel upgrade program.	Aging assets risk breakdowns, but upcoming fleet modernisation strengthens capacity and reliability. Weather limits operations.
Method	Coordinated multimodal operations. Strong contingency processes. Growing digital marketing and destination-led promotions. Focus on service quality.	Proactive and resilient operational methods align with lifeline service role. Digital strategies improving brand reach and market engagement.
Markets	Captive local market; aiming to grow younger tourist demographic. Competes with helicopter operator. No routine subsidies; moderate fare increases expected.	Internal funding and control give stability. Growth depends on attracting new customers while maintaining goodwill with residents amid fare.

Table 6: 5M Model (pt 2.) (Author's own, 2025)

2.4 Market Analysis

Broad Overview

When looking at the British holiday market, 36.9 million UK residents went for staycations in 2024, which is a drop from the 42.3 million in 2022. However, the domestic holiday market is expected to grow to 39.4 million in 2029 (Mintel, 2025a).

Spain remains particularly popular for British tourists in comparison to France and Italy due to its short travel distance, favourable climate and perception.

Consumer Behaviour

Cost remains key: 66% of Brits chose UK holidays in 2024 for affordability, while cheaper options like Turkey and Albania are rising. Sustainability also matters; 34% feel guilty about their impact, and 66% of millennials/Gen Z would pay more for eco-friendly travel (Mintel, 2025a).

Competitor Analysis

This competitor analysis will have a pricing strategy that looks specifically at the travel costs and ignores other factors, such as accommodation costs. While USPs will also analyse the destination to show the draw of the other competitor locations.

Categories	Pricing Strategy	USPs
Other Competitors in Scilly: Penzance Helicopters	Premium Pricing: £122.50 + per person one way. Day trip fairs at £199 round trip.	• Higher pricing for more convenient and speedier travel. • More scenic and adventurous way to travel. • Memorable trip.
Other Holiday destinations in the UK: Scottish Isles	Moderate costs: £25 per adult each way with North Link Ferries; roughly £100 for cars depends on where you are going from.	• Typically adventure and heritage orientated. • Activities, like hiking, wildlife spotting, boat trips. • Cultural aspects: whiskey tasting, clan castles, and Neolithic sites.
Overseas holiday destinations: Lanzarote	Low - to - moderate costs: the average return price from London to Lanzarote is around £152 , varies on the month e.g. £97 in March.	• Leisure and relaxing in the sun experience. • Appeals to the mass market. • Reputation for affordable sun spot.
Benchmark: IST	High costs: flights are £121 each way from Land's End (per person). Ferry (cheaper alternative) is £160 return per person	• Nature and tranquillity. • Only "Caribbean" turquoise water in the UK. • Hidden Gem • Also adventure opportunities.

Table 7: Competitor Analysis (Author's own, 2025)

2.5 SWOT

Strength • Large market share: IST, which was formerly a monopoly, only shares market share with Penzance helicopters • Upcoming fleet modernisations: Renovations in their passenger ferry with the Scillonian IV and the £40m vessel upgrade programme.	Weaknesses • Seasonal demand issues: IST sees year-round local demand, but tourist numbers remain tied to the seasonal window. • Pricing perception: Given the high cost of travel to the Isles of Scilly, this is a significant barrier, especially for younger, price-sensitive travellers.
Opportunities • Steady growth for domestic holidays: Although staycations have dipped from their pandemic peak, they are forecast to rebound slightly by 2029. • Eco-tourism and Sustainability Trends: This is a golden opportunity for ISSG given the environmental focus of the new vessels.	Threats • Aging demographics: Most people that utilise IST services are middle aged +. • Threat of substitutes: Overseas holidays are threatening to IST as they offer unique experiences at cheaper prices.

Table 8: SWOT (Author's own, 2025)

The SWOT highlights ISSG's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats, synthesising macro/micro factors with internal performance such as infrastructure, demand, and market position.

2.6 TOWS

Strength-Opportunities (SO) • Launch a sustainability-driven marketing campaign targeting Gen Z & Millennials in collaboration with Scillonian IV • Use Land's End Airport control to create seamless, branded travel packages (land, sea, air)	Weaknesses-Opportunities (WO) • Create seasonal student and youth ticketing discounts to increase off-peak demand • Expand spring/autumn cultural or nature-based events to widen seasonal window
Strength-Threats (ST) • Position Scilly as more accessible and premium-experience-based rather than cheaper. • Use storytelling via Instagram/TikTok ("Then & Now" reels, ferry captain diaries, old Scillonian ship footage) to build digital relevance and inspire younger adventure-seeking travellers.	Weaknesses-Threats (WT) • Avoid overdependence on older demographics by diversifying target audience via digital campaigns. • Offset infrastructure cost hikes (like St Mary's airport fee increases) with pre-purchased bundled experiences

Table 9: TOWS (Author's own, 2025)

The TOWS builds on the SWOT to outline strategies targeting younger generations, leveraging IST's infrastructure and the sustainable appeal of the new Scillonian IV.

3. SMARTER Objectives

3.1 Marketing Objectives

1. Increase Awareness Among Younger Audiences (18-35)

Increase social media impressions by 30% through TikTok and Instagram influencer campaigns, short-form video storytelling, and destination highlights.

Accomplished by: April 2026.

Evaluate: Use Meta Business Suite, TikTok analytics, and Google Trends.

Revise: Adjust platform mix or influencer strategy quarterly if growth stagnates.

2. Boost Engagement With Younger Audiences

Achieve a 25% increase in engagement rate and user-generated content across key platforms with people aged 18-35.

Accomplished by: February 2026

E: Engagement analytics across Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube Shorts.

Revise: Replace underperforming content formats or creators.

3.2 Financial Objectives

3. Grow Revenue From Younger Travellers

Increase revenue from 18-35-year-old travellers by 20% by introducing youth-centric offers such as group discounts, festival packages, and targeted promotions.

Accomplished by: September 2026 (End of Season)

Evaluate: Use booking data, promo code tracking, and CRM segmentation.

Revise: Test alternate incentive models (e.g. refer-a-friend).

4. Diversify Sales Through Bundled Packages

Generate **£n/a** in sales from bundled travel and event packages launching with a focus on summer 2026.

Accomplished by: Aug 2026.

Evaluate: Monthly sales and customer feedback.

Revise: Adjust packages or pricing mix if uptake is low.

5. Improve Off-Peak Revenue

Grow off-peak season bookings by 20% among younger audiences through digital nomad incentives and exclusive student promotions.

Accomplished by: February 2026.

Evaluate: Seasonal booking data comparison year-on-year.

Revise: Introduce flash sales or themed weekend offers as needed.

4. Strategy

4.1 Ansoff Matrix



Table 10: Ansoff Matrix (Author's own, 2025)

Market development supports the goal of engaging younger travellers (18–35), who see Scilly as remote and costly. Targeting this group leverages existing transport to reposition the Isles around sustainability, adventure, and unique experiences; opening new revenue streams and future-proofing the business.

4.2 STP

Segmentation

Table 11 outlines IST's current customer base, with residents and older tourists driving most demand. Youth audiences remain underrepresented, offering room for strategic growth.

Variable Type	Residents	Tourists	Youth
Demographic	wide age range, many over 40, Mixed gender, Income: Mid	Often 40+, partners or couples, retired empty-nesters Income: Mid-High	18-35, digitally connected, Income: Mixed
Geographic	Isles of Scilly	UK-wide, esp. SW England	Devon or Cornwall
Psychographic	Community-oriented, loyal, value reliability	Seek tranquillity, nature, heritage	Seek novelty, adventure, eco-conscious
Behavioural	Frequent or necessity-based travel, less price-sensitive	Seasonal, book in advance, often return yearly	Short breaks, digital-first, spontaneous or peer-influenced bookings

Table 11: Segmentation (Current) (Author's own, 2025)

The following table presents three youth segments identified as strategically relevant for IST's campaign. While not all will be targeted directly, each offers distinct behaviours and motivations that informed the targeting strategy and campaign direction.

Variable Type	Group 1: University Students	Group 2: Young Creatives	Group 3: Digital Nomads
Demographic	18-22, Full-time undergraduates Income: Low (student loans/part-time work) Education: University students (Exeter, Plymouth, Falmouth, etc.)	18-25 recent school or uni leavers, often between jobs/study Income: Low to moderate Education: College grads, early-career creatives	24-30 24-30 professionals with remote or freelance roles Income: Moderate to high Education: University grads, skilled workers in tech, marketing, design, etc.
Geographic	Live/study in uni towns like Falmouth, Plymouth and Exeter	Live in regional cities (e.g. Bristol, Brighton) or smaller towns; may travel from anywhere in the UK	Urban UK centres
Psychographic	Beliefs: Fun, freedom, friendship Interests: Festivals, socialising, outdoor activities	Beliefs: Self-expression, belonging, creativity Interests: Art, music, fashion, shared experiences, nature vibes	Beliefs: meaningful work, nature, self-optimisation, balance Interests: Remote work, wellness, productivity tools
Behavioural	Booking Habits: last-minute, look for deals Barriers: cost, awareness	Booking Habits: Self-organised, social media-driven Barriers: Travel cost, unclear transport options, group coordination	Booking Habits: book 1-2 week stays, looks for internet connection Barriers: internet reliability, lack of off-season amenities

Table 12: Segmentation (Strategy) (Author's own, 2025)

Values, Attitudes and Lifestyles (VALS)

The VALS framework was developed by Arnold Mitchell and is used to determine consumers' psychographic segments based on their motivations and resources (University of Minnesota, n.d.). For IST and their younger demographic, the segments most fitting are:

Experiences: Energetic, trend-driven thrill-seekers who chase fun, freedom, and social experiences.

Strivers: Ambitious but budget-conscious, they seek approval through cool, shareable moments.

4.3 Targeting

Group 2 is the primary target for this marketing campaign. Their interests and values align well with the current draws of Scilly already. But a secondary group is Group 1 due to their price-sensitive values that make them more likely for off-peak travel incentives, helping to extend the tourism season and support year-round demand.

Target Segment	Objectives Covered	Explanation
Primary: Group 2	1,2,3,4	Experience-seeking, social, and UGC-friendly; more willing to pay for curated events and partner add-ons-driving awareness, engagement, website traffic, and bundled package sales.
Secondary: Group 1	1,2,3,5	Highly price-sensitive and flexible around term breaks; most responsive to off-peak discounts and flash promos-driving awareness, engagement, website traffic, and off-peak revenue.

Table 13: Targeting (Author's own, 2025)

4.4 Personas

My personas reflect the two targeted groups for this campaign. Persona #1 (Mia Roberts) represents group 2 which is young creatives, the focus of this campaign. This group will be engaged with visually led storytelling, creative influences and curated experiences that share their values.

Persona #1 - Mia Roberts



Image is AI generated

Profile

Age: 23

Location: Bristol

Income: £23,000

Values: Creativity, authenticity, sustainability, community, exploration

Biography

Mia, 23, is a junior graphic designer in Bristol balancing freelance work and a café job. She seeks creative, sustainable experiences—spending weekends thrifting, exploring indie cafés, and attending festivals. Active on Instagram and TikTok, she shares her adventures and follows eco-conscious artists and travel influencers for inspiration.

Goals

- Discover visually inspiring destinations for creative projects
- Travel with friends and document experiences online
- Connect with communities that share sustainability values
- Find budget-friendly ways to explore new places

Pain Points

- Perceived high travel costs to unique destinations
- Difficulty coordinating affordable group travel
- Unclear transport options and logistics for remote spots

Psychographic Information

- Lifestyle: Active on Instagram & TikTok; attends art exhibitions, indie gigs, and pop-up events
- Personality: Creative, sociable, eco-conscious, adventurous
- Interests: Art, music, photography, vintage fashion, nature trails, sustainable travel

Figure 1: Persona #1

Persona #2 (Alex Harrison) reflects the secondary group that will be directed in this campaign, Group 1: university students. They will be reached through influencer collaborations, targeted off-peak promotions and group travel incentives.

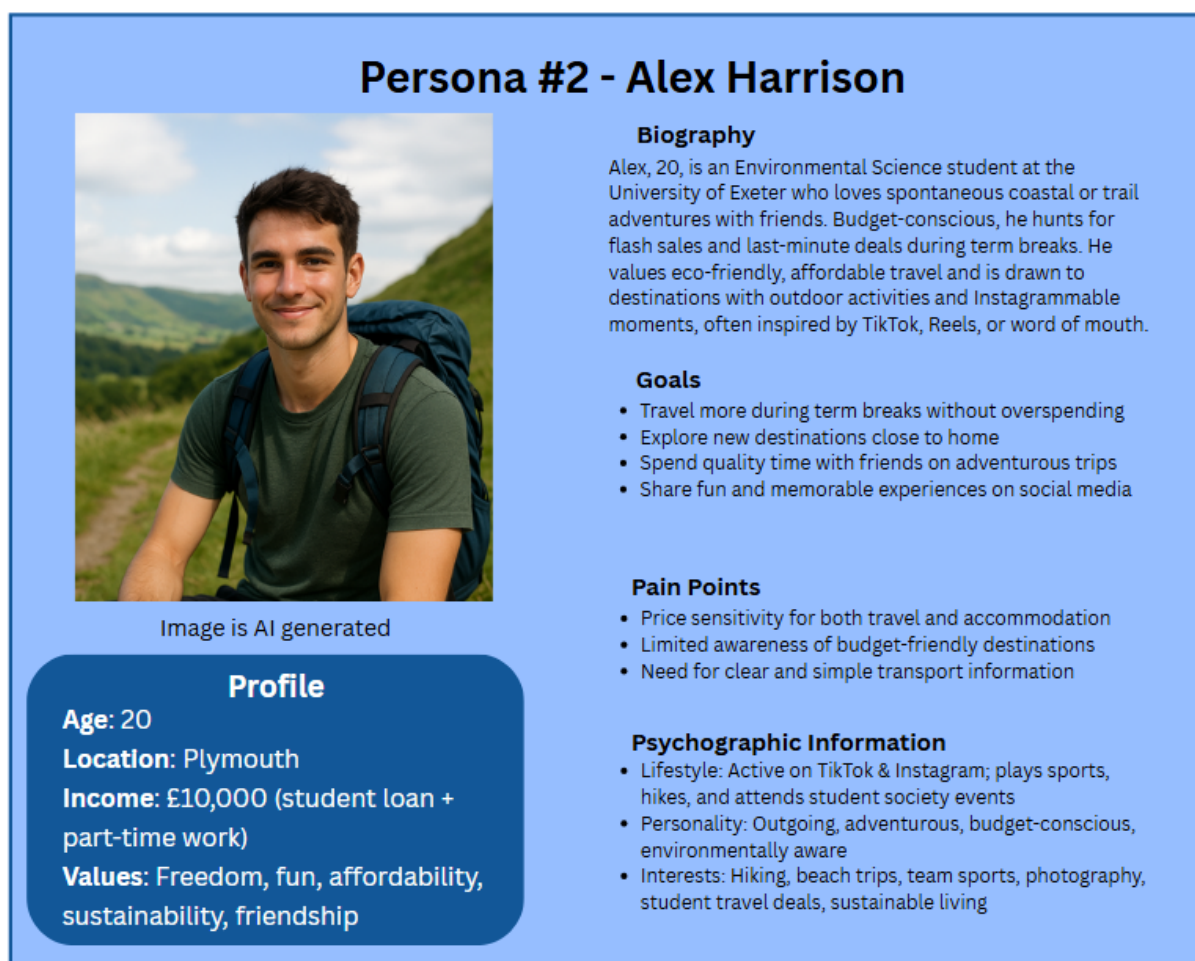


Figure 2: Persona #2

4.5 Positioning

To create the position statement, David Jobber's 4Cs framework will be used to structure the statement.

David Jobber's (2006) 4Cs Framework

C	How IST Achieves It
Clarity	Reliable transport to the isles of Scilly with different methods. IST emphasises escape, authentic and unique island hopping experiences.
Credibility	100+ years' heritage, skilled staff, and new fleet investment reinforce trust and safety.
Consistency	Messaging rooted in community, sustainability, and authentic island experiences across all touchpoints
Competitiveness	Differentiates from cheap overseas trips and other domestic holiday experiences by offering a trusted, eco-conscious gateway to a hidden UK gem.

Table 14: 4Cs (Author's own, 2025)

Position Statement:

Isles of Scilly Travel offers reliable multi-modal transport that highlights escape, authenticity, and island-hopping adventure. Backed by 100 years of heritage and new

fleet investment, IST builds trust through consistent, sustainable messaging and stands out as an eco-conscious alternative to overseas trips and helicopter rivals.

Perceptual Map

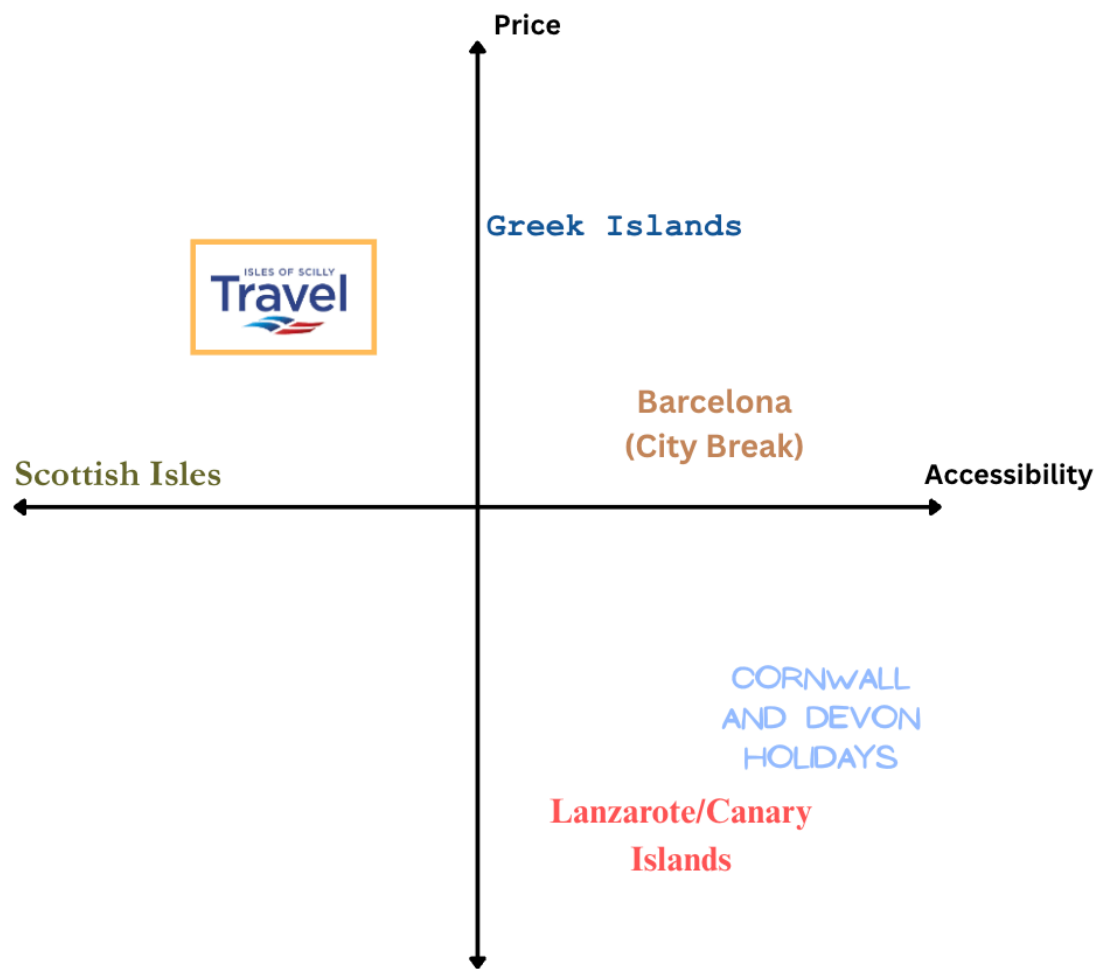


Figure 3: Perceptual Map (Author’s own, 2025)

5. Tactics

5.1 Campaign Big Idea and Key Message

Big Idea	The World’s First Island-Hopping Festival - a boutique, sustainable adventure where every island is a stage
Key Message	Discover five islands, five unique vibes. Over 4 days, each island will offer its own experience, blending Scilly’s natural charm with fresh events designed for younger audiences. From live music and wellness to art and adventure, the festival embraces sustainable travel while celebrating the islands’ individuality.

Key Details	• The festival will run early June to capture the end of university and will have good weather. • The festival will be designed to host 2500-3500 people (smaller than most festivals) • Events will run throughout the festival period but people attending are free to explore the islands fully whenever they like.
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Table 15: Campaign Idea (Author's Own, 2025)

Sample Festival Banner:

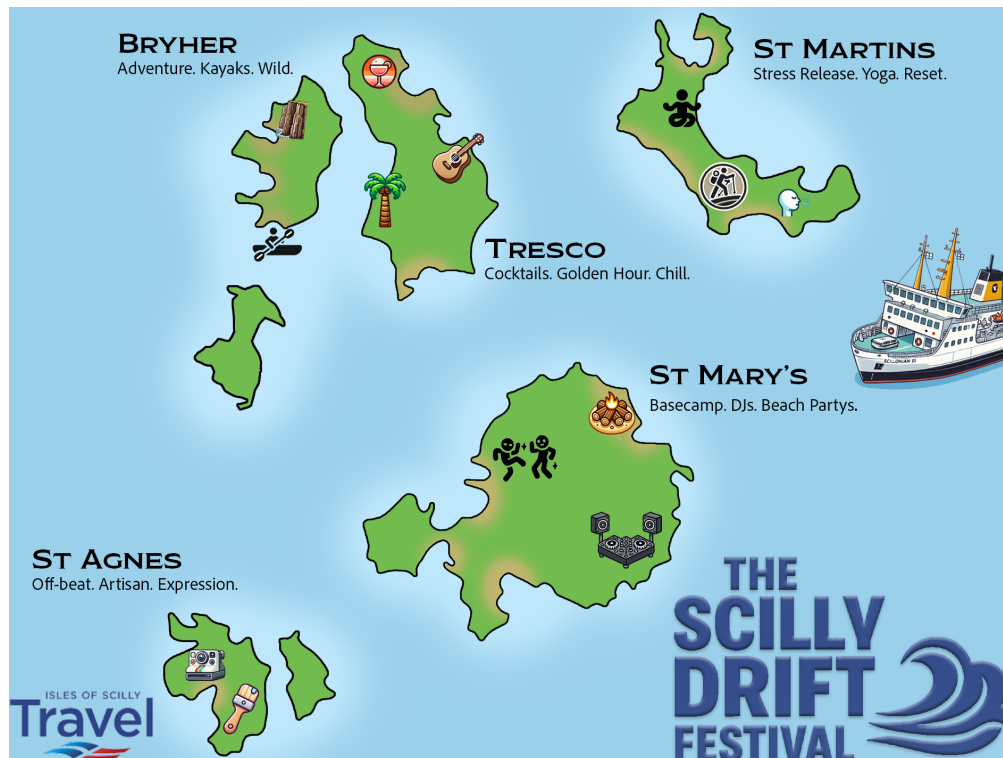


Figure 4: Festival Banner (Author's own, 2025)

Justification

Tourism events raise regional awareness and fit experiential marketing by creating memorable, emotional engagement (Esmaeili & Bod, 2024). For younger audiences, this can reposition Scilly from a one-off trip to a repeat destination. Currently framed around art, gastronomy, and nature, Scilly risks a mature image. An island-hopping festival incorporates youth-focused elements (music, wellness, and adventure), enriching its brand with dynamic associations (Keskin et al., 2023). This attracts younger visitors while future-proofing the Isles' competitiveness.

IST already have experience running events and festivals such as Ocean Scilly and Taste of Scilly Food Festival. This shows they have the knowledge and expertise already to operate a small-scale festival. The Scilly Drift differentiates itself with its appeal to younger demographics.

5.2 Marketing Mix

P	Current State	Tactical Implication
Product	Lifeline transport links by sea (Scillonian III ferry, freight ship Gry Maritha) and air (Skybus, 8 aircraft). Offering unique island-hopping, turquoise waters (“Caribbean of the UK”), tranquillity, wildlife, and eco-tourism potential.	- Bundle ferry travel + festival pass into one ticket, reducing friction and adding perceived value. - Each island programmed with a unique “vibe” (music, wellness, adventure, artisan) to showcase Scilly’s diversity as a product extension.
Price	Ferry £160 return pp; flights £121 each way, Sea operations profitable (£2.9m profit), but aviation runs at a loss (-£0.20m in 2024, forecast -£0.58m in 2025) (Isles of Scilly Steamship Group, 2024b)	- Introduce <i>student/youth discounts</i> in shoulder months (March-April, September) to extend seasonality. - Offer bundles which allow for students to get added perks for an increase in price.
Place	Penzance (ferry), Land’s End, Newquay & Exeter (flights, seasonal). Distribution is limited by the weather.	Partner with universities in Exeter, Bristol, Plymouth for distribution channels (student unions, travel fairs).
Promotion	limited presence on Instagram/TikTok, current content emphasises on heritage, reliability, tranquillity, and older demographics	- Hero campaign: “<i>The World’s First Island-Hopping Festival</i>”. - Influencer & micro-influencer partnerships - Improve performance on Instagram/TikTok - Promote digital nomad lifestyle on Scilly

Table 16: 4Ps (Author’s own, 2025)

The 4Ps show how the festival extends IST’s offer: bundling ferry travel with passes adds value, student discounts and tiered pricing boost off-peak demand, and partnerships with universities plus refreshed social media make Scilly more accessible and aspirational.

P	Current State	Tactical Implication
People	200 staff +, including pilots, crew, engineers; strong local roots and loyalty	Student volunteers/internships in event management, giving younger staff buy-in and keeping costs lean.
Process	Coordinated multimodal transport; integrated booking system; strong contingency planning for weather disruptions	Seamless ticketing: one QR code covers ferries + festival entry.
Physical Evidence	Assets: Scillonian III (aging), Skybus planes, Gry Maritha freight ship, Land’s End Airport and upcoming £40m+ fleet modernisation programme	- Festival wristbands doubling as ferry passes → tangible, memorable evidence of the campaign. - Pop-up installations (photo spots on each island: “I danced on St. Mary’s / I chilled on Tresco”).

Table 17: 3Ps (Author’s own, 2025)

The 3Ps show how people, process, and physical evidence enhance the experience: student volunteers cut costs and add authenticity, streamlined ticketing boosts convenience, and branded wristbands plus photo spots reinforce the festival identity.

5.3 Content Strategy

The content strategy is designed to captivate younger demographics with Scilly’s natural beauty, while also promoting the festival.

Content Themes	Details
Island Vibes	Showcase each island as a stage with its own unique festival experience. Content will be delivered via TikTok and Instagram Reels to highlight diversity and create shareable, youth-friendly storytelling.
UGC	Launch challenges such as “Five Islands in Five Days”. Winners get free ferry tickets or merchandise. This incentivises user participation, extends reach organically, and turns visitors into co-creators, aligning with Fournier & Lee’s (2009) model of brand communities.
Behind-the-Scenes Travel	Humanise the journey by showing the ferry crews, festival volunteers, and the inter-island boat rides as part of the adventure. Short-form video diaries of student travellers, drone shots of turquoise waters, and crew interviews connect audiences emotionally while highlighting the ease of travel.

Table 18: Content Strategy (Author’s own, 2025)

5.4 Channel Breakdown (using RACE)

Reach

This phase focuses on raising Scilly’s awareness among younger groups, a key challenge for IST. Tactics include UGC, influencer marketing, and university partnerships.

Social Media

Boosting IST’s presence on youth platforms will raise awareness. The top three by active users are Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok (Lindlahr, 2024), with Instagram the most popular among 16–34s (Mintel, 2025b).

Content Type	Purpose	Platforms	Example formats
Festival Promotion	Build hype and awareness for Scilly Drift Festival	Instagram	Short-form video/image teasers, countdown posts, influencer collabs, UGC reels
Digital Nomad Promotion	Position Scilly as an off-season remote working destination	Instagram	Lifestyle reels of working by the sea, blog-style posts
Paid Ads	Extend reach and precision-target youth and remote worker segments	Instagram	Carousel ads, targeted video ads, geo/demographic targeting

Table 19: Social Media Content Type (Author's own, 2025)

Sample Instagram Post:

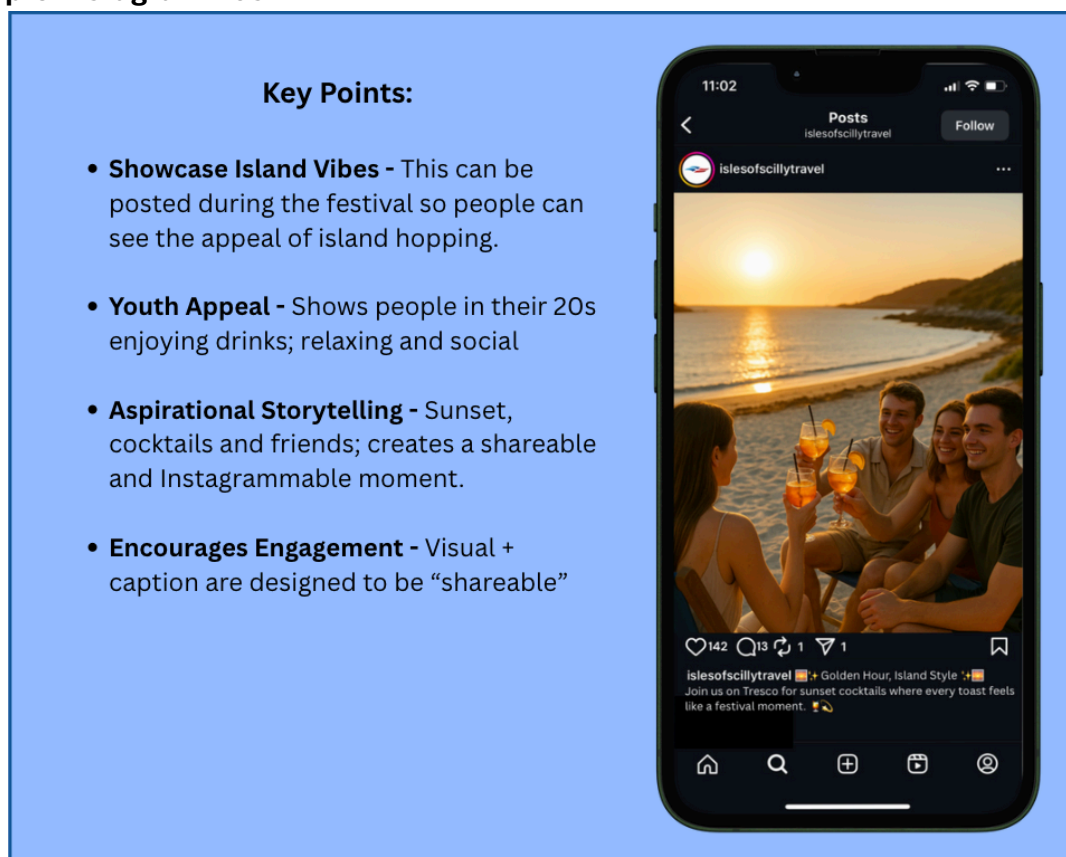


Figure 5: Sample Instagram Post (Author's own, 2025)

The budget covers digital marketing, engagement, festival experience, and operations. Within digital, £4,000 goes to social ads, £15,000 to influencers, while content is produced in-house at no cost.

Sample Instagram Story:

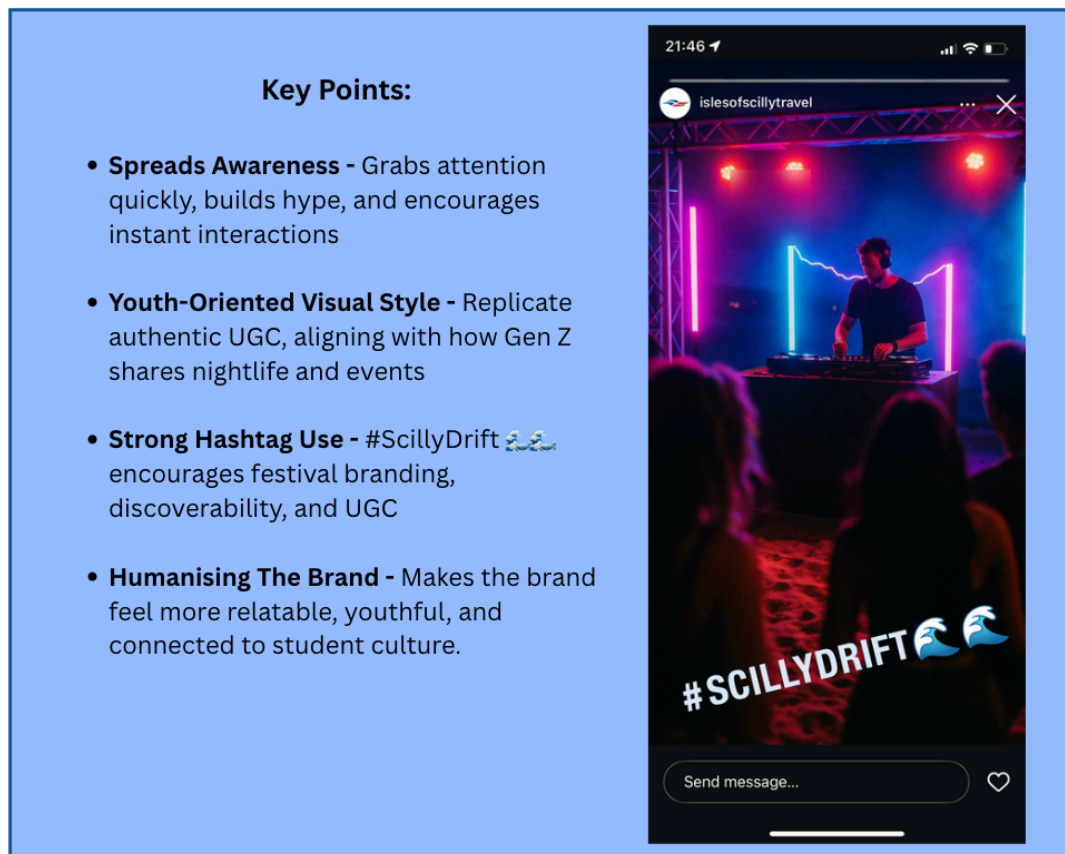


Figure 6: Sample Instagram Story (Author's own, 2025)

This Instagram Story demonstrates how real-time content can drive festival engagement. Its ephemeral nature mirrors the excitement of a live event, while the branded hashtag and UGC-style visuals encourage interaction, shareability, and FOMO-driven attendance.

Key Metrics:

- Impressions
- Follower Growth
- Engagement Rate

Influencer Marketing

Influencer marketing builds awareness with younger audiences. Mid-sized influencers (50k–250k) offer affordability and closer alignment with campaign values and target groups.

Sample Influencer:

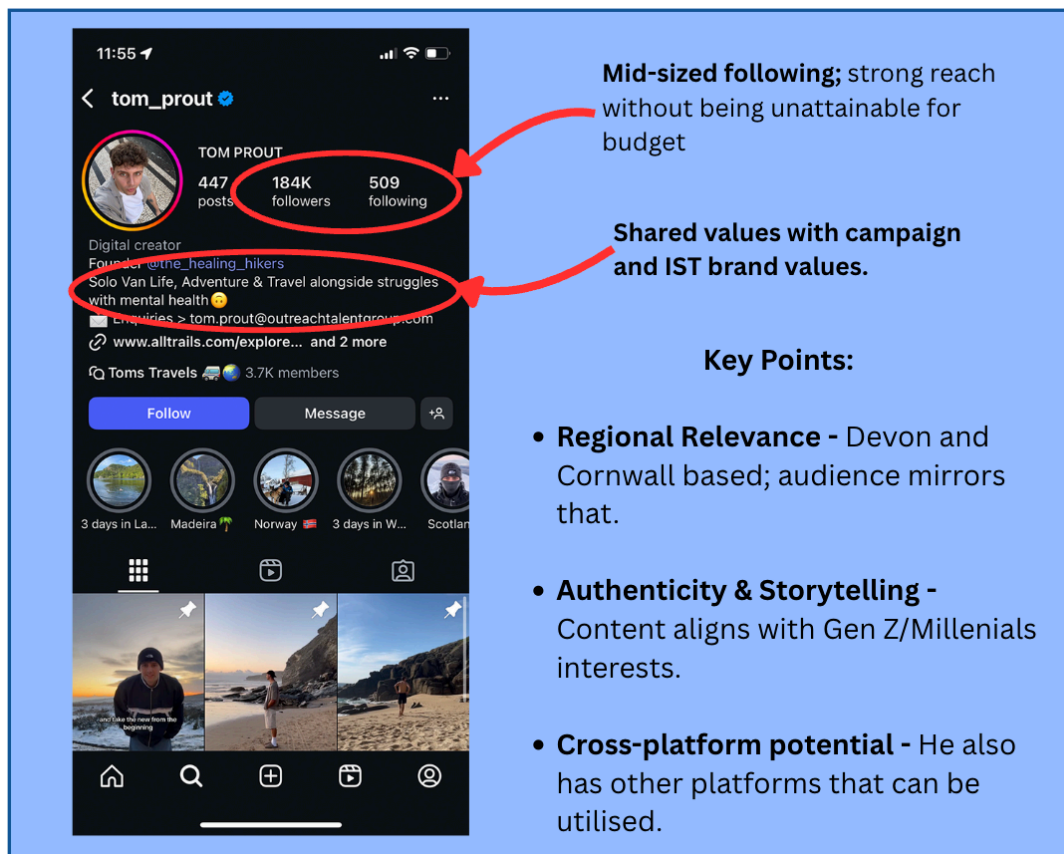


Figure 7: Sample Influencer (Author's own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Engagement per post
- Total Reach/Views
- Content Shares

Partnerships with Universities

Working with universities is a key way to target Group 1, university students. Pop-up stalls, co-branded student union events, and on-campus appearances are an authentic way to spread awareness through a key part of the target demographic. IST can utilise student ambassadors here to run the stalls. You can offer them free Festival Passes for their cooperation.

Sample University Partnership Ideas:

Pop Ups

- Branded stalls at Exeter, Falmouth, and Plymouth Universities.
- Eye-catching visuals (Discover Five Islands. Five Vibes.) to make Scilly stand out against other travel brands.
- Freebies (cups, tote bags, sunglasses) encourage brand recall.
- Staff in festival merch; helps to humanise IST and make it more student-friendly rather than corporate.



Image is AI Generated

Figure 8: Pop-ups (Author's own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Footfall
- QR codes scanned
- Promotional Item Uptake

Campus Media & Advertising



- Sponsored features in student newspapers/magazines
- Targeted Reach; Student publications are read by thousands of students within your core regions
- Credibility; being in the campus magazine makes it feel like an advert and more trustworthy.
- Cost-Effective; advertising with student magazines doesn't cost much.

Figure 9: Campus Media (Author's Own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Estimated Readership
- Digital Article Views
- Print Distribution

Act

The Act phase turns interest into interaction by driving students to explore the microsite, vote in Instagram polls, and swipe through the festival map.

Microsite/Landing Page

This is the central page where people will first begin to explore the festival and see the experiences to be had. This central page introduces the festival, featuring an interactive island map, details on student discounts and bundles, and sign-ups for email updates.

Sample Landing Page:

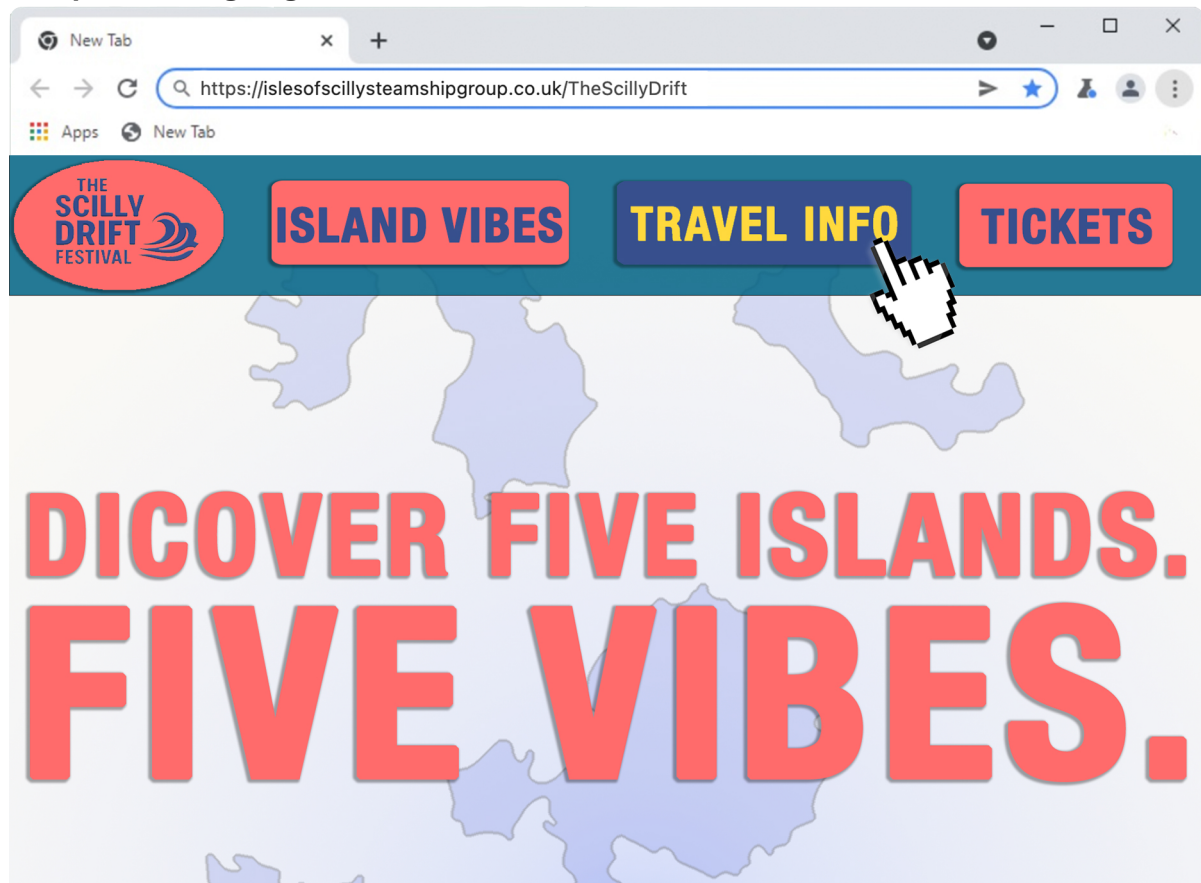


Figure 10: Landing Page (Author's own, 2025)

Element	Features	Act Objective
Landing Page	• Hero Headline “Discover Five Islands. Five Vibes.”; instantly	• Reinforces unique positioning, sparking curiosity to scroll.

	communicates the campaign USP • Vibrant Colour Palette; creates a bold, festival-like first impression. • Clear Navigation Buttons; make key actions impossible to miss.	• Attract attention and encourage users to explore further. • Reduces friction; encourages immediate engagement (click-throughs).
Navigation Buttons	• Island Vibes; allows users to explore the themes of each island through an interactive map. • Travel Info; users can find the different ways to access the festival using IST services + bundle and student discount offers. • Tickets; CTA; highlights conversion path; allows people to get festival passes.	• Get students to explore each island's vibe, creating personal connection • Reduce uncertainty around logistics & cost for students • Drive intent-to-purchase behaviour early

Table 20: Website Experience (Author's own, 2025)

Sample Travel Info Page:

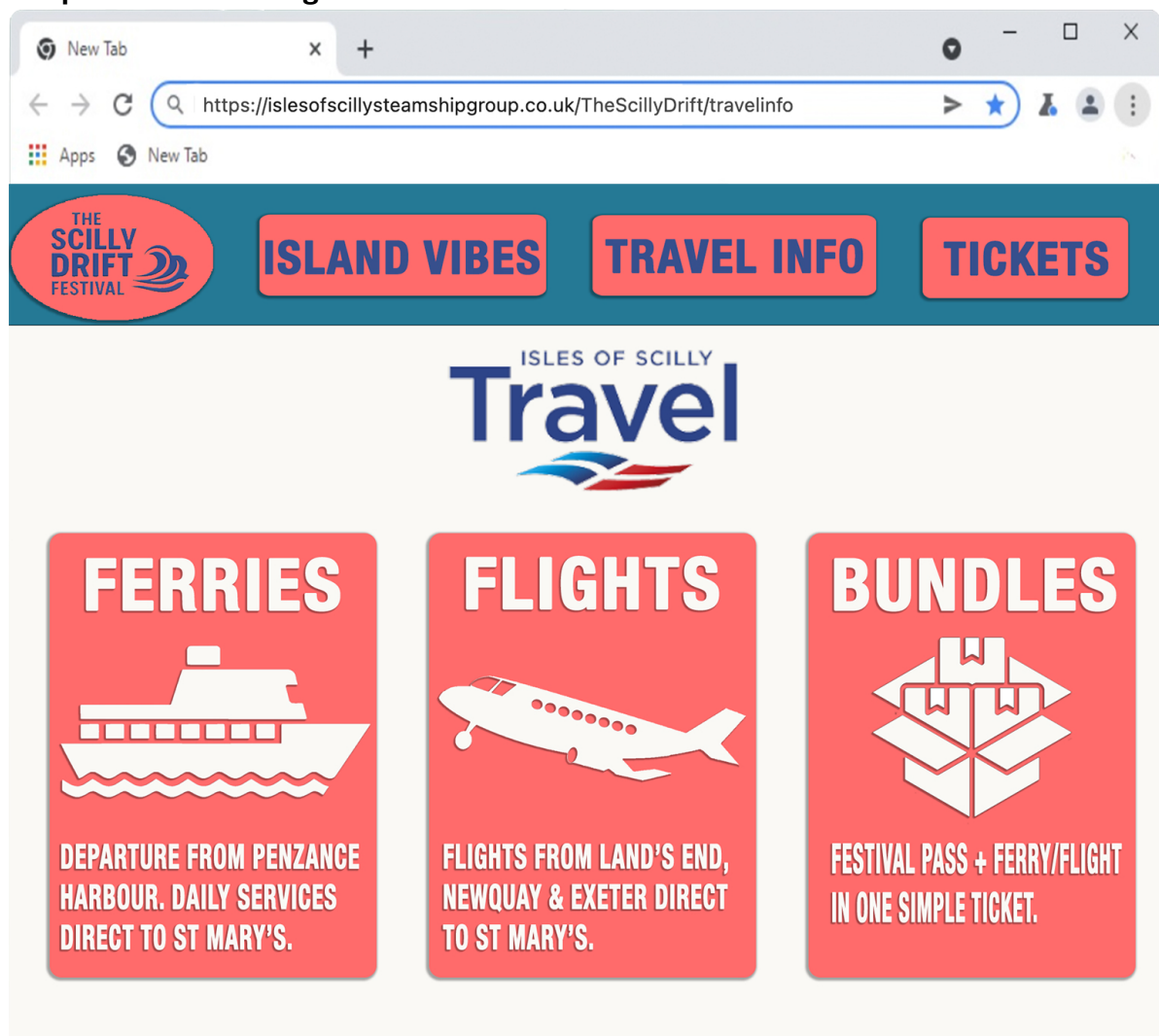


Figure 11: Travel Info Page (Author's Own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Bounce Rate
- Time on site
- CTR for each navigational page
- CTA links

Social Interactivity

This section leverages social media platforms to change impressions into active engagement. By using polls, quizzes, and countdowns, the campaign can transform passive scrolling into two-way interaction. This humanises Isles of Scilly Travel (IST) and makes the festival feel youth-focused and approachable.

Element	Purpose	Act Objective
Polls	• Encourage playful interaction and self-expression	• Get students to picture themselves at the festival, deepening consideration
Countdowns	• Build urgency before ticket drop	• Drive anticipation and FOMO, prompting return visits
Swipe-ups	• Provide direct path to microsite where people can deepen their connection with the festival.	• Move students from engagement to conversion journey

Table 21: Social Interactivity (Author's own, 2025)

Sample Polls Post:

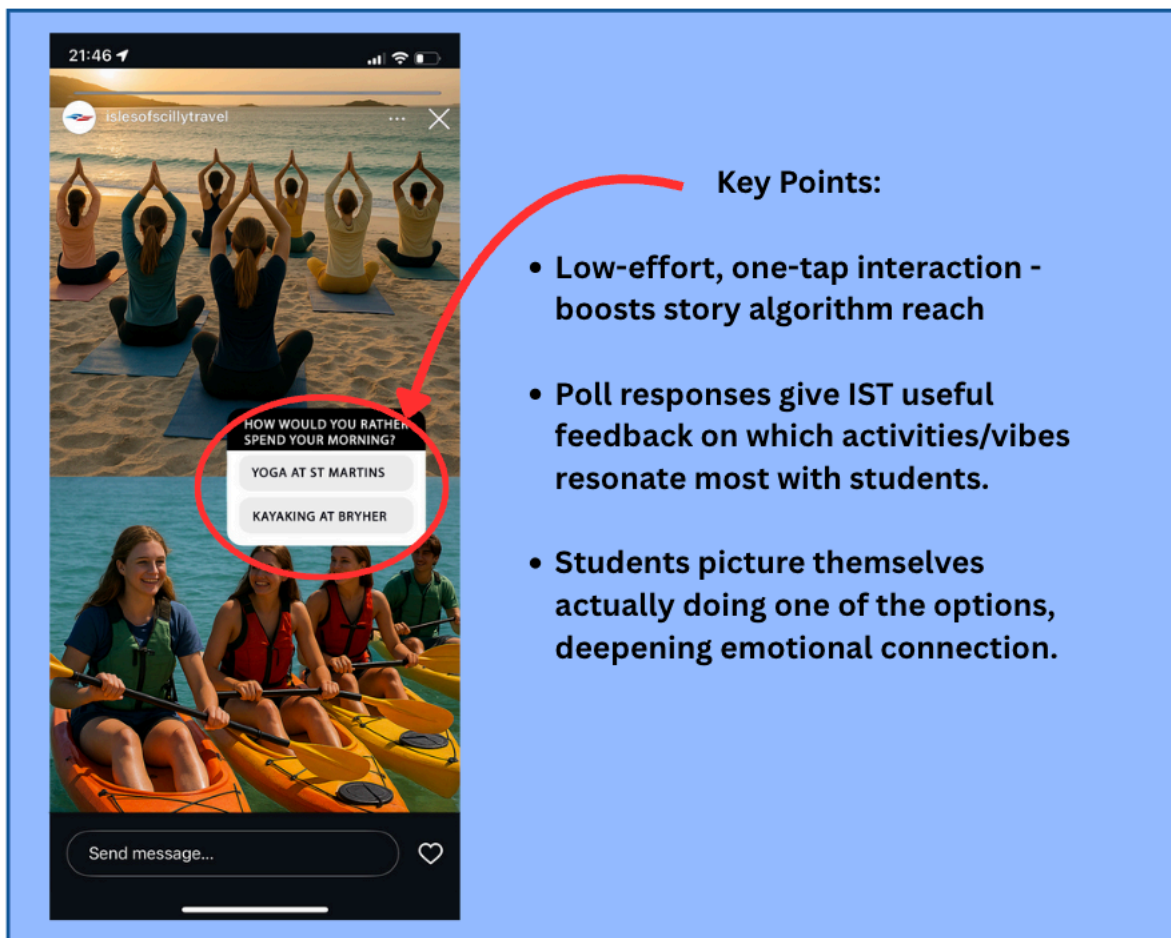


Figure 12: Polls (Author's own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Number of responses
- Engagement rate
- Story retention
- CTR to microsite

Convert

The conversion stage turns interest into ticket sales by removing barriers and emphasising affordability, as price is the key driver for the target demographic.

Student Discount

Student discounts at checkout and in shoulder months cut cost barriers, incentivise bookings, and extend IST's season by capturing student demand in off-peak periods.

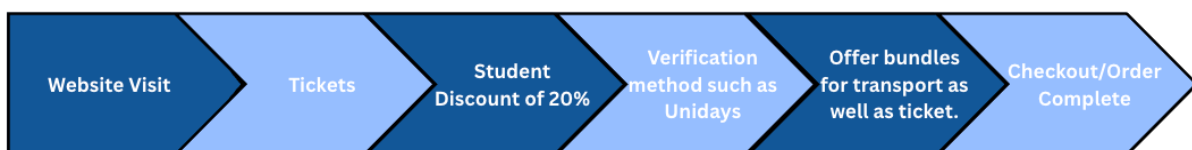


Figure 13: Purchase Flow (Author's own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Discount code redemption rate
- Conversion rate (compare with vs without discount)

Festival programme/events

At the Convert stage, IST must present a clear and appealing festival programme. Specific events are essential to justify ticket purchases and demonstrate value. The programme balances music, wellness, adventure, and artisan culture -giving students diverse reasons to book.



Figure 14: Logo (Author's own, 2025)

Island	Theme	Experiences	Headline Event
St Mary's	Social Basecamp/Party	Main Island; where most hotels are. DJ sets, beach parties, coffee crawls, hangout hubs	Thursday & Saturday Night: "Neon Beach Rave" - headline DJ set with neon lighting on the sand
Tresco	Chill & Connect	Second Main Island; lots of hotels. There can also be a designated spot for tents for extra accommodation. Beach bar, sunset picnics & cocktails, social games, open mic.	Sunday Afternoon: "Golden Hour Cocktail Gala" - DJ + mixology evening at beachfront bar
St Martin's	Wellness	Set up temporary yurts for extra accommodation Morning yoga, meditation on the beach, breathwork, trails	Friday Morning: "Meditation on the Beach" - a guided group meditation.
St Agnes	Artisan	Creative workshops, local food pop-ups, storytelling, hidden gigs, hammocks	Saturday Day: "Island Makers Market" - live art, crafts, and street food under festoon lights
Bryher	Adventure	People can bring tents for camping here as well. Kayaking, coasteering, beach bonfires, cliff jumping	Friday Evening: "Cliffside Cinema" - outdoor film screening projected onto cliffs.

Table 22: Festival Program (Author's own, 2025)

The islands all have experiences that can be done throughout the 4 days. They'll also have a major headline event that encourages people to travel to all the islands throughout the festival.

Festival Pass

The festival pass equates to the ticket for the event. The pass gives access to the festival experiences, headline events and transport across the Isles.



Figure 15: Festival Pass (Author's own, 2025)

While IST does not directly control inter-island transport, strategic partnerships with local boating associations could allow festival shuttles to operate during event days. The core pass would therefore bundle mainland-to-Scilly transport with festival entry, while inter-island travel would be supported through collaborations.

Key Metrics:

- Festival Pass sales volume
- Booking Journey Completion Rate
- Channel Attribution

Bundles

The purpose of the bundles is to make travel + ticket purchase seamless and affordable, reducing friction for consumers who might otherwise be put off by having to organise ferry/flight and event tickets separately.

Bundle Type	Details	Conversion Objective
Basic Festival Bundle	• Scillonian Ferry (Penzance ↔ St Mary's) + Festival Pass	• Attract budget-conscious students with an affordable • Simplifies the conversion process with a one-click package
Express Festival Bundle	• Skybus Flight (Exeter/Newquay/Land's End) + Festival Pass	• Appeal to time-limited youths • More accessible for many
Group Bundle	• 4 festival passes at a discounted price	• Encourage friendship groups to book together • Boosts ticket volume
Premium Add-on Options	• Can be added to any of the bundles or regular tickets. • Offers free sailing classes + accommodation in the yurts on St Martins	• Upsell additional services • Increases average booking value

Table 23: Bundles (Author's own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Bundle Sales % (Compare with standalone Festival Passes bought)
- Bundle Type Uptake
- Upsell Conversion Rate

Engage

The engage stage is where one-time tourists of Scilly become repeat visitors. The importance of this section is to make the experience of tourists memorable and pleasant so that they would want to come again. Encouraging festival goers to share their experiences online and take part in UGC is pivotal. This allows attendees to expand the campaign's reach beyond the event itself, generating advocacy and long-term loyalty.

UGC Campaign

The premise is to make each island also have a unique aspect that causes people to want to take photos in each location. This helps promote the island-hopping idea to the people viewing UGC content. This is enhanced by offering people a free trip next year for those who post the best content on Instagram using the hashtag “#ScillyDrift”. Below is a table that shows spots that could be set up to encourage photo taking on each island.

Island	Instagrammable Spot	UGC Hook
St Mary's	DJ stage with LED light tunnel or arch	Visual spectacle at night; festival-goers film Stories/Reels

Tresco	Cocktail beach bar with neon sign (“ <i>Golden Hour</i> ”)	Encourages golden hour photos & group shots, highly shareable
St Martin’s	Sunrise yoga circle with colourful mats	Peaceful aesthetic for wellness/Instagram Reels content
St Agnes	Artisan market with local murals	Combines local art + festival brand, creative UGC opportunity
Bryher	Cliffside viewpoint with branded surfboard sign (“ <i>You’ve Reached Bryher Drift</i> ”)	Creates a sense of achievement + perfect selfie backdrop

Table 24: UGC locations (Author’s own)

Sample UGC Post:



Figure 16: UGC Post (Author’s own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Number of tagged submissions
- Number of posts under #ScillyDrift

- UGC volume

“Scilly Drift Stories” Content Series

Each month, IST highlights the “best moments” on each island, which leads up to the following campaign year. It can highlight specific attendees’ experiences, which helps build loyalty and turns them into advocates. Keeps Instagram more active with authentic storytelling content.

Element	Purpose	Engage Objective
Monthly Island Highlights	Keep Instagram active year-round with authentic content	Maintain engagement beyond festival season and build loyalty
Attendee Spotlights	Feature real student stories/photos	Turn attendees into advocates and amplify word-of-mouth
Countdown to Next Festival	Create monthly anticipation rhythm	Bridge into next year’s Reach stage with built-in audience

Table 25: Content Series (Author’s own, 2025)

Key Metrics:

- Views
- Engagement (likes, comments, reposts)
- Saves (especially for countdown posts)

Merchandising

The goal of merch is to extend the festival experience beyond the event itself, turning attendees into brand advocates and building long-term loyalty whilst also providing another source of revenue. The merch itself will be sold at locations on Scilly for only those attending the festival.

Merch	Description	Engage Objective
Hoodie / T-Shirt	Festival; creates year-round visibility on campus.	• UGC fuel: Students show off merch in Instagram posts/stories. • Loyalty driver: Wearing merch keeps Scilly in mind throughout the year.
Wristband	Wristband which has its logo and more subtle keepsake afterwards.	

Table 26: Merch (Author’s own)

Sample hoodie (merch):



Figure 17: Sample Hoodie (Author's own, 2025)

6. Action

6.1 Pre-Campaign Gantt Chart

The pre-campaign will run from September to December. Preparing for a campaign launch at the start of 2026. This period will be used to set up the foundations of the campaign.

Task	Description	When			
		Sept 25	Oct 25	Nov 25	Dec 25
Start creating microsite	• Begin microsite design (Sep) • Produce creative assets (Oct) • Build site (Nov) • Microsite testing (Dec)				
University Prep	• Secure university partnerships (Exeter,				

	Plymouth, Bristol SUs). (Sep) • Prep of pop-up stall kits for January Uni activations (Nov) • Confirm campus media slots (Nov)				
Prep Influencer Collaborations	• Select influencers (Sep) • Confirm partnerships (Sep) • Influencer “Save the Date” hints (Dec)				
Social Media	• Prepare Instagram assets e.g. posts and story templates (Nov) • End-of-year teaser: “2026 starts here - Scilly Drift is coming.” (Dec)				
Festival Prep	• initial supplier + partner outreach (Nov-Dec) • make collaborations with Scilly ferry-taxis (Nov-Dec)				

Table 27: Pre-Campaign Gantt Chart (Author’s own, 2025)

6.2 Campaign Rollout Timeline: January 2026 - December 2026

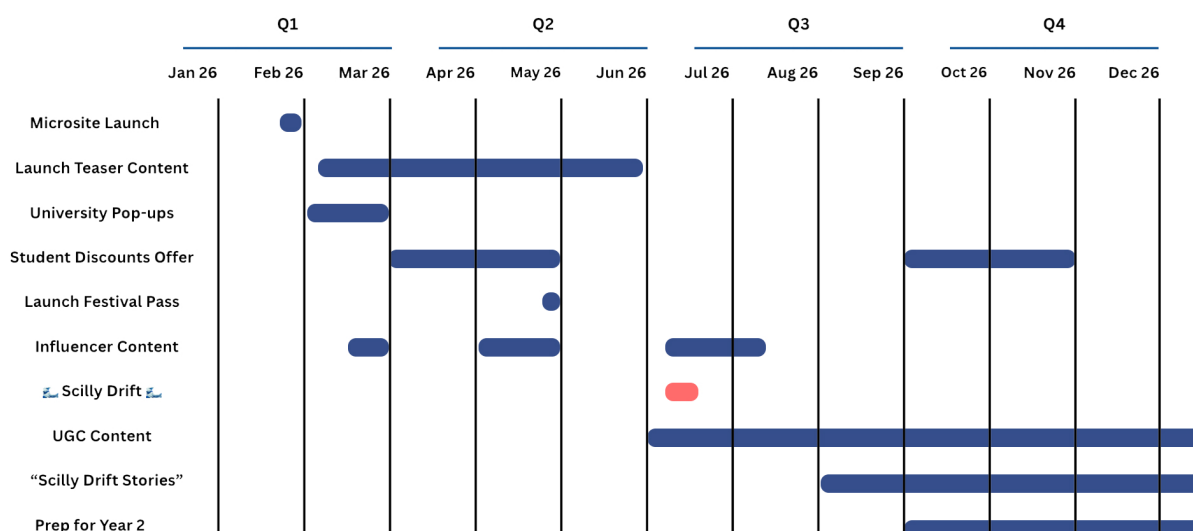


Figure 18: Timeline (Author’s own, 2025)

Below is a list of content that leads up to the festival and the justification for the placement within the campaign year.

Detail	Justification
Microsite Launch	Launched in February to act as the campaign’s central hub well ahead of ticket sales.

Launch Teaser Content	Running February-June provides an early awareness window. February catches students before exams, while April-May builds hype during ticket release and before festival.
University Pop-ups	Positioned in February in line with term time. Students will begin gaining awareness of the Isles of Scilly prior to Easter break.
Student Discounts Offer	The student discounts (outside of the festival) will be applied during the more off-peak months around the beginning and end of University.
Launch Festival Pass	Festival Pass is launched, this includes bundle release, at the end of April to give enough time for IST to see ticket sails performance. During period where people are in an excited state after teaser and influencer content.

Table 28: Timeline Justifications pt 1. (Author's own, 2025)

This table explores content during and post the festival, explaining the justification for its placement.

Detail	Justification
Influencer Content	March-April is teaser announcements, May-June is conversion-driven posts around ticket bundles, and June covers live festival content. Extending into July allows post-event highlights and FOMO messaging.
Scilly Drift Festival	The end of the second week of June; this date is picked for its good weather and close to Universities finishing so will be easy to get Uni student groups.
UGC Content	Starts in June for live sharing, and runs to December to amplify "best moments" and community storytelling
"Scilly Drift Stories"	Begins August to keep post-festival buzz alive. Monthly storytelling highlights maintain visibility across the quieter late-summer/autumn months and builds hype for the next campaign year.
Prep for Year 2	Scheduled in Q4 when campaign insights and UGC have been gathered. It gives the team at IST preparation for the next campaign year.

Table 29: Timeline Justifications pt 2. (Author's own, 2025)

6.3 Roles & Responsibilities

This table demonstrates the key roles and responsibilities required to fulfil the Scilly Drift Festival campaign effectively.

Roles	Responsibilities
Campaign Manager (IST Marketing Lead)	Oversees the full campaign. Manages agency, budget, and reporting. Coordinates with transport ops to link travel and festival messaging.
Interns/Student Ambassadors	Support on-the-ground university pop-ups, distribute promotional materials, moderate online community, select UGC for reposts, and assist during festival week.

Creative Team	Produce creative assets (posters, social templates, microsite visuals). Also assist with social media posts. Ensure brand consistency across digital and physical channels.
Web Developer	Build and maintain the campaign microsite, including ticketing, interactive maps, and integration with social feeds. Handles troubleshooting and analytics setup.
Festival Operations Team	Handle supplier/partner coordination, stage/event set-up, transport logistics, and safety during the festival week.
Influencers	Act as campaign amplifiers by creating teaser, travel prep, and live festival content. Drive awareness and FOMO among younger demographics.
Partners (Local Suppliers + Scilly Ferry-Taxis)	Provide local collaborations that enhance authenticity and accessibility. Cross-promote campaign messages to their customer bases.

Table 30: Roles (Author's own, 2025)

6.4 Budget

The budget is split into four channels: digital marketing, engagement, festival experience, and operations. Digital marketing allocates £4,000 to social ads, £15,000 to influencers, with content created in-house at no cost.

Item	Budget	Calculations	Justification
Social Media Advertising	£4,000	Instagram ads cost £1,000/month. The ads will run during the 4 months of teaser content (Barraclough, 2023).	The launch teaser content for the festival will be the most important time for gaining awareness. Paid ads will be beneficial
Influencer Marketing	£15,000	- Micro-influencers (10k-100k followers) = \$100-\$500 per post - Mid-tier influencer (100k-500k followers) = \$500-\$5,000 (Hitchcock, 2025).	Assuming using 5 micro-influencers and 3 mid-tier influencers with 2 posts each. The budget also gives a bit so that the influencers can also be offered trips to Scilly.
Content Creation	£0	IST already has the facilities to create their own content. Production of 6 short-form videos + 50 asset pack for ads/UGC reuse.	Short-form video is the fastest-growing travel discovery which will be necessary for the campaign. (Yu, 2024).

Table 31: Digital Marketing Budget (Author's own, 2025)

This budget supports the campaign's presence beyond digital touchpoints.

Item	Budget	Calculations	Justification
University Ambassador Program	£0	20 ambassadors each receive a festival pass	Festival passes act as a sufficient incentive while keeping campaign costs lean.
Campus pop-ups	£6,000	£2,000 per campus for setup, permits, travel, and promo materials	Pop-up stands directly engage students with festival buzz, giveaways, and booking information. Affordable versus traditional media buys.
Merch	£5,350	500 hoodies × £12 = £3,000; 5,000 wristbands × £0.47 = £2,350 (synerg, 2023).	Hoodies = exclusive ambassador identity; wristbands = mass giveaways for awareness.

Table 32: Engagement and Outreach Budget (Author's own)

This budget allocates resources to staging, performers, licensing, bar outsourcing, and security to deliver the “Scilly Drift” festival as the campaign’s flagship experiential event.

Item	Budget	Calculations	Justification
“Scilly Drift” - Festival	£21,600	- Outdoor Mid-sized staging is £2000 x2 (Nielsen, 2019). - Speakers £2,500 (Ingram, 2024) - Dj cost £350-400 for 4-6 hours. Needed for 2x nights (Bark, 2024). - Full Premise License for serving alcohol or hosting late-night music £800 (Ingram, 2024) - Bar cost = £0; outsource the bar service to an external company for a small fee. - Security £20/hour per guard. 10 hour days, 20 guards, 4 days = £16,000	Creates immersive youth-focused experiences (music, wellness, culture) Drives UGC & influencer content through shareable moments Supports experiential marketing → stronger awareness & engagement Aligns Scilly with Gen Z/Millennial values (adventure, sustainability)

Table 33: Festival Experience Budget pt 1. (Author's own, 2025)

This budget covers essential attendee infrastructure such as toilets, showers, and temporary accommodation to ensure a safe and enjoyable multi-day festival experience.

Item	Budget	Calculations	Justification
Toilets & Showers	£26,000	100 Portaloos (1 week) = £3,000 (Toilets on The Go, 2025). 30 Portable Showers (1 Week) = £4,200 - Servicing = £3,500 - Total Water - 48,000 L = £15,300 water in & out	Most the Portaloos and showers will be in campsites with some also stationed by beach DJ sites.
Accommodation	£20,000	25 yurts priced at £200/night x 4 = £20,000 (Roundhouse Yurts, 2022).	Most accommodation will be on campsites, with additional options in already existing Airbnb's and hotels. Yurts will provide temporary elevated camping. Can house 4 people.

Table 34: Festival Experience Budget pt 2. (Author's own, 2025)

This budget funds the campaign's backbone through microsite hosting, partnerships, and a contingency reserve, ensuring smooth delivery and flexibility in the face of unexpected costs.

Item	Budget	Calculations	Justification
Microsite Development and Hosting	£1000	Maintenance - £850 (security updates, content tweaks, backups,) Hosting: £12.5/month × 12 = £150	The microsite underpins the campaign as the central information hub.
Partnerships (with local companies)	£36,050	Estimated subsidy to local boat associations to operate festival shuttles across five islands during event week (£2,430 per island × 5).	Festival passes include inter-island travel as part of the experience. Since IST does not directly operate these services, partnerships with ferry/taxi providers are essential.
Contingency Fund	£15,000	10% of overall budget reserved	Adds as a buffer in case anything goes wrong or unexpected extra costs.

Table 35: Operational Costs (Author's own, 2025)

Total Cost = £150,000

**Assumptions made:*

- Most video content and microsite development will be done in-house.
- Assuming the event size will be 3000-4000 people

Campaign Budget Allocation

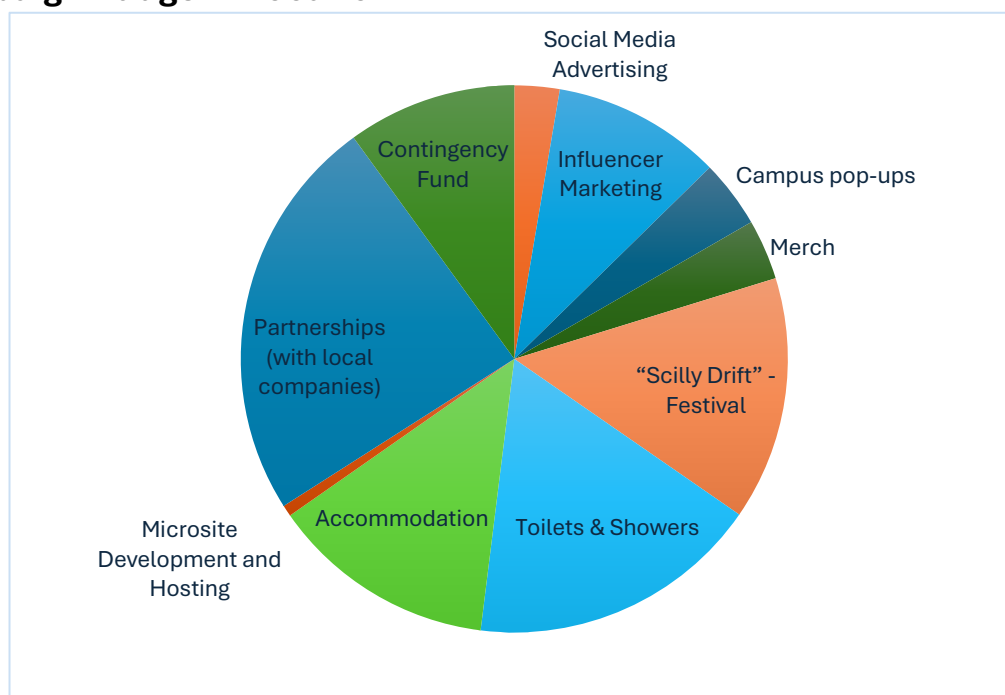


Figure 19: Budget Pie Chart (Author's own, 2025)

7. Control

7.1 KPIs & Metrics

The following KPIs focus on marketing-related objectives, ensuring awareness and engagement are measurable throughout the campaign.

Objective	RACE Stage	Core KPI's	Measurement Tools	Review Frequency
1. Increase Awareness Among Younger Audiences (18-35)	Reach	+30% social media impressions - Influencer reach & views - Follower growth	- Meta business suite - Influencer dashboards - Instagram insights	Monthly
2. Boost Engagement With Younger Audiences	Reach/Act	+25% engagement rate - UGC volume & shares - Microsite CTR	- Meta business suite - Hashtag tracking - Google Analytics (GA4)	Monthly

Table 36: Marketing Objectives (Author's own, 2025)

The financial objectives are tracked separately, with KPIs designed to measure revenue growth, bundled package performance, and off-peak sales opportunities.

Objective	RACE Stage	Core KPI's	Measurement Tools	Review Frequency
3. Grow Revenue From Young Travellers	Convert	+20% revenue from 18-35 y/o - Student discount code redemptions	- Online checkout tracking - Booking Data - Promo-code usage	Quarterly
4. Diversify Sales Through Bundled Packages	Convert	- Bundle sales % (vs standalone passes) - Bundle type uptake (Basic, Express, Group, Premium add-ons)	- Online checkout tracking - CRM	Quarterly
5. Improve Off-Peak Revenue	Convert/Engage	+20% off-peak bookings - digital nomad offers	Seasonal booking comparison (YoY)	Bi-annual

Table 37: Financial Objectives (Author's own, 2025)

7.2 Financial Evaluation

Pricing

The following table outlines individual pricing for festival passes, student discounts, and merchandise. The main goal is to overcome cost-conscious youth buyers with affordable pricing.

Item	Price	Rationale
Student Discounts (Ferries & Flights)	20% off original price	Makes festival accessible for 18-25s, aligning with youth targeting and affordability.
Festival Price	£75	Covers event costs while keeping entry affordable for young audiences.
Merch	Hoodie = £40 Wrist Band = £3	Hoodie is more premium priced but in comparison to other festival merch fair. Justified by a lower more affordable souvenir offered as well.

Table 38: Pricing (Author's own, 2025)

Table 39 highlights bundle pricing that combines transport, passes, and optional extras, offering convenience and small savings while maximising perceived value.

Bundle	Price	Rationale
--------	-------	-----------

Basic Festival Bundle	£220	Includes pass + return ferry. £15 cheaper than buying separately, making it attractive without eroding margins
Express Festival Bundle	£310	Includes pass + return flight. £15 cheaper than buying separately.
Group Bundle	£800 (£200 pp)	Includes festival passes + ferry travel for 4 ppl. It reduces per-head cost, incentivising group travel.
Premium Add-ons	+£25-£40 for classes; +£120/per person for yurts/glamping (min 2 people/max 4 people)	Flexible upsells increase revenue. Yurts pitched cheaper than hotels but premium vs tents.

Table 39: Bundle Pricing (Author's own, 2025)

Returns on Investment (ROI)

The scenarios below forecast potential revenue outcomes under conservative, realistic, and optimistic assumptions, based on 3,000 attendees.

Scenario	Estimated Revenue	ROI %
Conservative - assumes everyone just buys the cheapest offer (Group bundle) no add-ons	£600,000	300%
Realistic - a mix of different offers (and add-ons); + 50% merch	£750,000	400%
Optimistic - more Express/Premium bundles. Average cost is £300/person	£900,000	500%

Table 40: ROI on 3000 attendees (Author's own, 2025)

ROI Calculation:

$$ROI\% = \frac{Revenue - Cost}{Cost} \times 100$$

Checkpoints

Table 41 outlines the performance checkpoints for the campaign, providing clear thresholds (100%, 75%, 50%, 25%) to evaluate progress against KPIs and guide corrective action where objectives are not being met.

Performance Level	Performance Description	Implication	Action
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100% of Objectives Achieved	+25% engagement uplift, 30% increase in awareness, 20% revenue growth from 18-35s, strong bundle & off-peak sales	Campaign is on track or exceeding targets. ROI is strong and sustainable.	Maintain momentum. Reinvest surplus budget into top-performing channels. Plan retention activities.
75% of Objectives Achieved	+18-20% engagement uplift, awareness and revenue moderately increased, bundles performing but below forecast	Campaign generating good results but not full potential. ROI moderate.	Re-optimize content/ad placements. Adjust influencer mix. Reallocate underperforming spend.
50% of Objectives Achieved	+12-13% engagement uplift, awareness/revenue growth limited, off-peak demand weak	Campaign underperforming. ROI risk and objectives at risk.	Conduct diagnostics: refine audience targeting, creative testing, channel performance. Re-strategize urgently.
25% of Objectives Achieved	<10% engagement uplift, minimal awareness growth, poor ticket/bundle uptake, off-peak targets unmet	Critical underperformance. ROI severely at risk, campaign failing.	Immediate crisis response: pause failing tactics, redirect budget to paid reach, and escalate contingency measures.

Table 41: Checkpoints (Author's own, 2025)

7.3 Risk & Mitigation

Figure 20 shows a risk heatmap evaluating internal and external risks during the campaign.

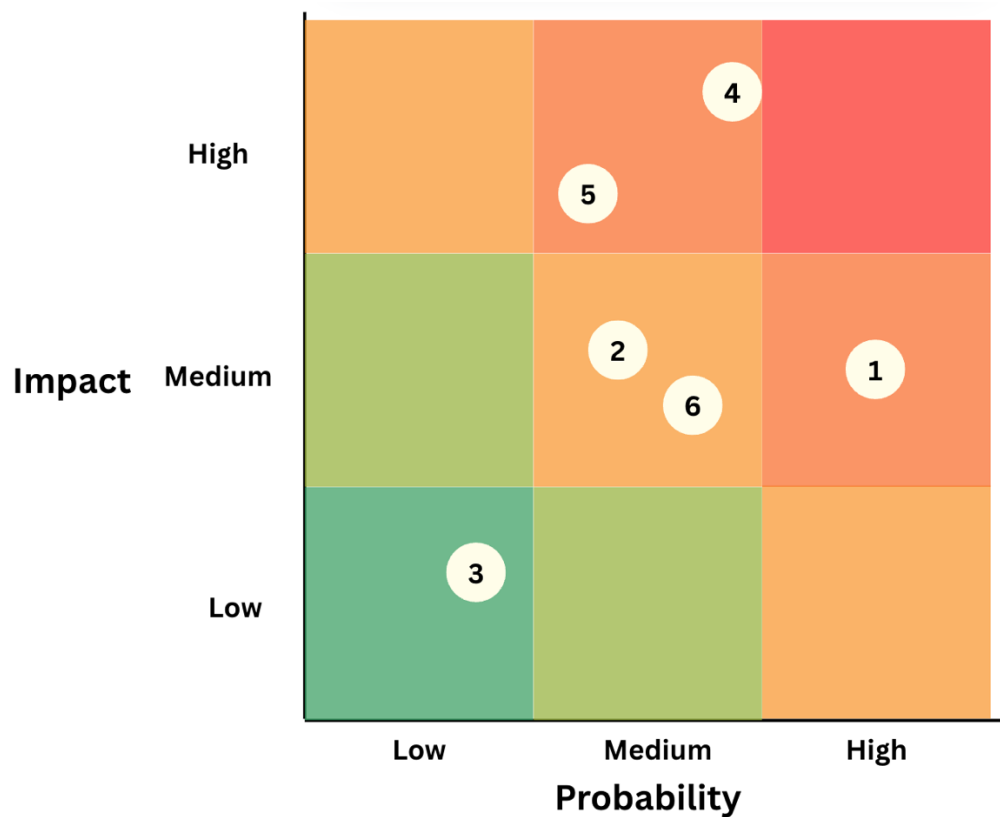


Figure 20: Risk Heat Map (Author's own, 2025)

The table below highlights the internal risks, explaining the risk and what can be done to mitigate it.

Risk #	Risk Description	Justification	Mitigation
1	Operational Cost Overruns	Extra staffing, merch production, or pop-up costs could eat into margins.	Prepare to use contingency funding, prioritise spending in tactics with clear ROI.
2	Reputation & Safety Risks	Overcrowding, poor service, or accessibility issues could harm ISSG's reputation and trust.	Cap ticket sales to 3500. Provide staff training; highlight sustainability and inclusivity.
3	UGC/Engagement Fatigue	Reliance on community-generated content may decline if audiences don't contribute.	Offer more rewards to spur more content and engagement.

Table 42: Internal Risks (Author's own, 2025)

Table 42 explores external risks which could affect the campaign.

Risk #	Risk Description	Justification	Mitigation
4	Weather Disruption	Severe storms can cancel ferries/flights in both peak and off-peak seasons	Build in flexible refund/transfer policy

5	Low Ticket Update	Risk of failing to hit awareness/revenue objectives	Use contingency fund to up paid-advertising and influencer marketing.
6	Off-Peak Demand Falls Short	Digital nomad campaign may fail if Scilly is seen as too remote or costly.	Use LinkedIn (the largest work social-media website) with targeted ads. Highlight testimonials and Wi-Fi-ready spaces.

Table 43: External Risks (Author's own, 2025)

8. Long-Term Recommendations

Table 43 is an Ansoff Matrix that explores long-term opportunities for IST. It focuses on the other segments that haven't been covered during the campaign.



Table 44: Long-Term Ansoff Matrix (Author's own, 2025)

8.1 Market Penetration

Market penetration leverages IST's existing assets and consumers. A proposed loyalty scheme, *ScillyMiles*, would reward regular travellers. Unlike IST's current Travel Club, which discounts fares (Isles of Scilly Travel, 2017), *ScillyMiles* mirrors air-miles models like BA Avios or Virgin's Flying Club.

Tactic	Description	Purpose
Tiered Rewards	Bronze, Silver, Gold levels, e.g. after 5 trips = priority boarding, after 10 = free seat upgrade.	Encourages repeat travel and builds aspiration.

Cross-Channel Integration	Points earned and redeemed across ferries, Skybus flights, and inter-island services.	Strengthens brand loyalty by rewarding multi-channel travel.
Digital Integration	Mobile app/portal tracks journeys, points, and sends personalised offers.	Enhances engagement, captures customer data, supports targeted marketing.
Partner Benefits	Discounts at cafés, bike hire, eco-tours and local businesses with the ScillyMiles card/app.	Promotes and strengthens local economy, adds value beyond transport.

Table 45: Long-Term: Loyalty Program (Author's own, 2025)

Sample App Screen:



Figure 21: ScillyMiles App (Author's own, 2025)

8.2 Product Development

Product development is the creation of a new product for an existing market. The introduction to work-event packages is efficient. These packages allow companies to book Scilly as a unique “work-from-anywhere” destination, blending productivity with leisure, and providing added value for existing travel audiences.

Sample Brochure:



Figure 22: Brochure (Author's own, 2025)

Below shows the features of the “Work from Scilly” package. With options of whether it is included or optional.

Feature	Description	Optional/Included
Travel	Return ferry or Skybus tickets with priority boarding.	Included
Accommodation	Cost of hotel/Airbnb/guesthouse	Included
Workspace Facilities	Access to meeting rooms, breakout spaces, outdoor work areas and WiFi.	Included
Team-building activity	Guided hike, seal-spotting boat trip, or kayaking.	Optional
Catering	Local seafood dinners or catered meeting lunches.	Optional
Island Tours	Guided cultural or nature tours of the Isles.	Optional
Evening Socials	Group dinner, networking drinks, or bonfire gathering.	Optional

Table 46: Long-Term: Work-Event Package (Author's own, 2025)

8.3 Diversification

Diversification introduces new products to new markets. For IST, ‘Eco-Lodges’ would extend into hospitality while reflecting its values, sustainable cabins on St Mary’s or St Martin’s built with local materials, renewable energy, and rainwater harvesting.

Feature	Justification
Sustainably powered	Uses renewable energy (solar/wind) and rainwater harvesting, aligning with rising eco-tourism demand.
Designed for year-round use	Provides IST with off-peak revenue, reducing reliance on the summer holiday season.
Locally sourced materials	Supports island economy, strengthens IST’s community roots, and reduces carbon footprint.
Integrated travel packages	Bundles accommodation with IST transport (ferry/Skybus), creating new revenue streams and brand loyalty.

Table 47: Long-Term: “Eco-Lodges” (Author’s own, 2025)

Sample “Eco-Lodges”:



Figure 23: Eco-Lodges (Author’s own, 2025)

9. Conclusion

This report has shown that while the Isles of Scilly Steamship Group holds a proud legacy as the lifeline of the islands, its future growth depends on engaging younger audiences who value sustainability, adventure, and unique experiences. By implementing the proposed island-hopping festival campaign, supported by digital-first storytelling, youth-focused pricing, and bundled travel packages, IST can reposition itself as an accessible yet aspirational destination. Combined with fleet modernisation and long-term initiatives such as eco-lodges and loyalty programmes, this strategy will not only drive immediate awareness and revenue but also secure the organisation’s long-term resilience and relevance in an increasingly competitive tourism market.

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